

Charles Harless

Software Engineering Manager

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Engineering Leadership | Web & Mobile Applications | Cloud & Media Platforms

Summary

Software Engineering Manager with experience leading and scaling engineering teams in large, complex organizations. Led engineering teams of up to 15 engineers across web and mobile platforms delivering reliable and scalable business-critical systems. Improved delivery predictability and modernized platforms while maintaining a sustainable development pace.

- **Scaled Impact:** Launched Disney Movies Anywhere with 20M+ users on web & mobile platforms
- **Delivery Excellence:** Reduced engineering backlog by up to 75%, improving release cadence
- **Operational Efficiency:** Drove 15% infrastructure cost reduction through automation
- **Workplace Culture:** Improved team morale by 40-50% through coaching and recognition.
- **Reliability at Scale:** Maintained 99.9% uptime for distributed backend services and APIs

Skills

- **People Leadership & Execution:** Team Building, Coaching & Mentorship, Career Development, Performance Management, Roadmap Planning, Agile Development
- **Organizational & Operational Leadership:** Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Incident Management, Capacity Planning, Delivery Predictability
- **Architecture & Systems:** AWS, Distributed Systems, System Design, Scalability & Performance, Microservices, Web Services & REST APIs, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Languages & Tools:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript/TypeScript, MongoDB, MySQL, GitHub

Experience

Software Engineering Consultant

Thinking Bear Consulting, Los Angeles, CA

07/2023 - Present

- Owned delivery and technical direction for high-traffic AWS-hosted web applications
- Translated business goals into execution plans and technical roadmaps
- Improved scalability and performance by 15% through architectural refinements and tuning
- Reduced infrastructure costs by 15% through automation, governance controls, and metrics

Software Engineering Manager

Brightcove, Boston, MA

01/2023 - 06/2023

- Managed 14 engineers across 2 teams building AWS-based media and web applications
- Increased release frequency by 20% through process improvements and automation
- Reduced engineering backlog by 75% using capacity planning and prioritization
- Improved developer engagement by 40% through individualized growth plans and mentoring

Software Development Manager

Amazon Prime Video, Culver City, CA

01/2021 - 06/2022

- Managed 7 engineers delivering media workflows integrated with 25+ backend services
- Owned delivery for systems in critical media pipelines, maintaining speed, quality, and stability
- Reduced time-to-market by 15% through iterative delivery, delegation, and accountability
- Coordinated security updates across 2,000+ applications, achieving 100% compliance in 1 week
- Established development programs that increased team morale and engagement by 50%

Technical Lead**NBCUniversal**, Universal City, CA*04/2016 - 12/2020*

- Defined architectural vision for enterprise platforms supporting 23,000+ internal users
- Led cross-functional teams modernizing legacy portals, increasing workforce productivity by 10%
- Introduced coding standards, improving release quality and reliability by 15%

Technical Lead**Walt Disney Studios**, Burbank, CA*11/2011 - 04/2015*

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere, supporting 20M+ users with 99.9% uptime
- Led cross-functional team of 15 people building multi-platform streaming applications using Java
- Designed and implemented high-availability REST APIs handling millions of daily transactions
- Partnered closely with Product and Operations teams to improve reliability and performance

Senior Software Engineer**Walt Disney Parks & Resorts**, Glendale, CA*12/2005 - 10/2011*

- Standardized application architecture, improving platform scalability by 20%
- Designed semantic data models that improved reuse and system integration across systems

Teaching

Computer Science Instructor**UCLA Extension - Los Angeles, CA***August 2015 - Present*

- Instructed Java, Web Applications, and Data Structures courses
- Earned a 4.7/5.0 instructor rating through clear explanations and real-world examples
- Developed project-based curriculum increasing student engagement by ~20%

Education

- Master of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of California Los Angeles
- Bachelor of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of Alabama

Certifications

- Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance
- Certified Scrum Product Owner, Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate, Databricks